



# Issued Regardless

## Phone-Pouch Distribution Held Flat Across Nine Terms of Rising Online Invigilation

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### Background

Every exam sitting still issues one sealed phone pouch per candidate. A rising share of sittings now run entirely online, where no candidate sits in a room to seal one. Has the pouch protocol been asked to justify itself since?

### Aims

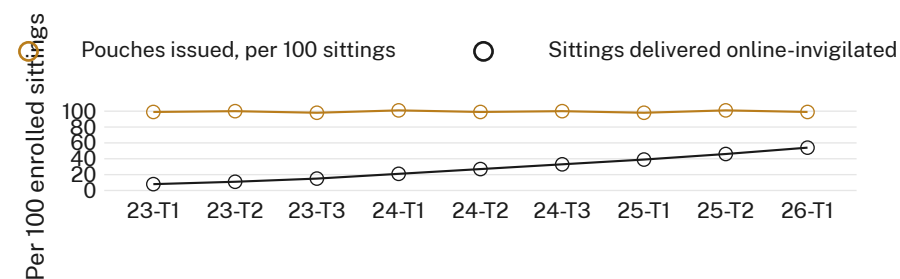
- Track pouches issued per exam sitting across nine teaching periods
- Compare issuance against each period's online-invigilated share
- Establish whether the protocol has ever been reviewed against delivery mode

### Methods

- 9 teaching periods (2023-T1 to 2026-T1) · Office of Research Outputs procurement and distribution logs · pouch counts reconciled against enrolled-sitting totals
- Linear trend fit of pouches issued per sitting against each period's online-invigilated share
- Distribution protocol held constant throughout; no override on record for any sitting type

### Results

Pouches issued per enrolled sitting held between 98 and 101 per hundred across all nine periods, regardless of delivery mode. The trend shows no association with the rising online-invigilated share.



Phone-pouch issuance held at 98–101 units per 100 enrolled sittings across nine teaching periods (T1 2023 – T1 2026), even as the online-invigilated share of sittings rose from 8% to 54%.

### Discussion & conclusions

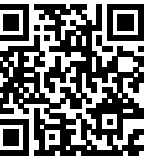
The pouch travels with the sitting record, not the sitting itself. No period shows a reduced allocation for online-invigilated cohorts. Next: audit whether an online-invigilated sitting's pouch is collected unopened, stored, or simply written off the tally.

### References

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Distribution records only; no pouch openings observed directly.

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“One per sitting, whether or not anyone will check.”

Pouch issuance held flat across nine teaching periods, even as the online-invigilated share rose sixfold.